

Question:

At birth, the least developed part of the brain is the

Answer Choices:

- A. visual system
- B. thalamus
- C. frontal lobe
- D. brain stem
- E. parietal lobe
- F. cerebellum
- G. cortex
- H. basal ganglia
- I. hypothalamus
- J. limbic system

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>

The reasoning process :

To determine the least developed part of the brain at birth , we need to consider the developmental stages of the brain . The brain develops in an orderly manner , with different regions maturing at different stages . The development of the brain can be divided into three stages :

- 1 . Germinal stage : The formation of the brain begins during embryonic development .
- 2 . Neuroblastic stage : The basic structure of the brain develops , and the major brain regions start to form .
- 3 . Neurofibrillar stage : The brain regions refine and mature .

The brain stem , which regulates basic functions such as breathing , heartbeat , and blood pressure , is one of the earliest developing regions . It starts forming early in embryonic development and continues to mature throughout fetal development .

In contrast , the cerebral cortex , which is responsible for higher-order functions like thinking , problem-solving , and decision-making , is one of the last regions to mature . It continues to develop significantly after birth , especially during childhood and adolescence .

Given this information , we can conclude that the least developed part of the brain at birth is the cortex , which is responsible for higher-order functions .

Therefore , the correct answer is G . cortex .

</think><answer> G . cortex </answer>

